PRD-04 · Company research and company-specific loops

Status: Shipped (v0.1.2) · **Updated:** 2026-10-30 · **Design:** DD-04 Research and dossiers

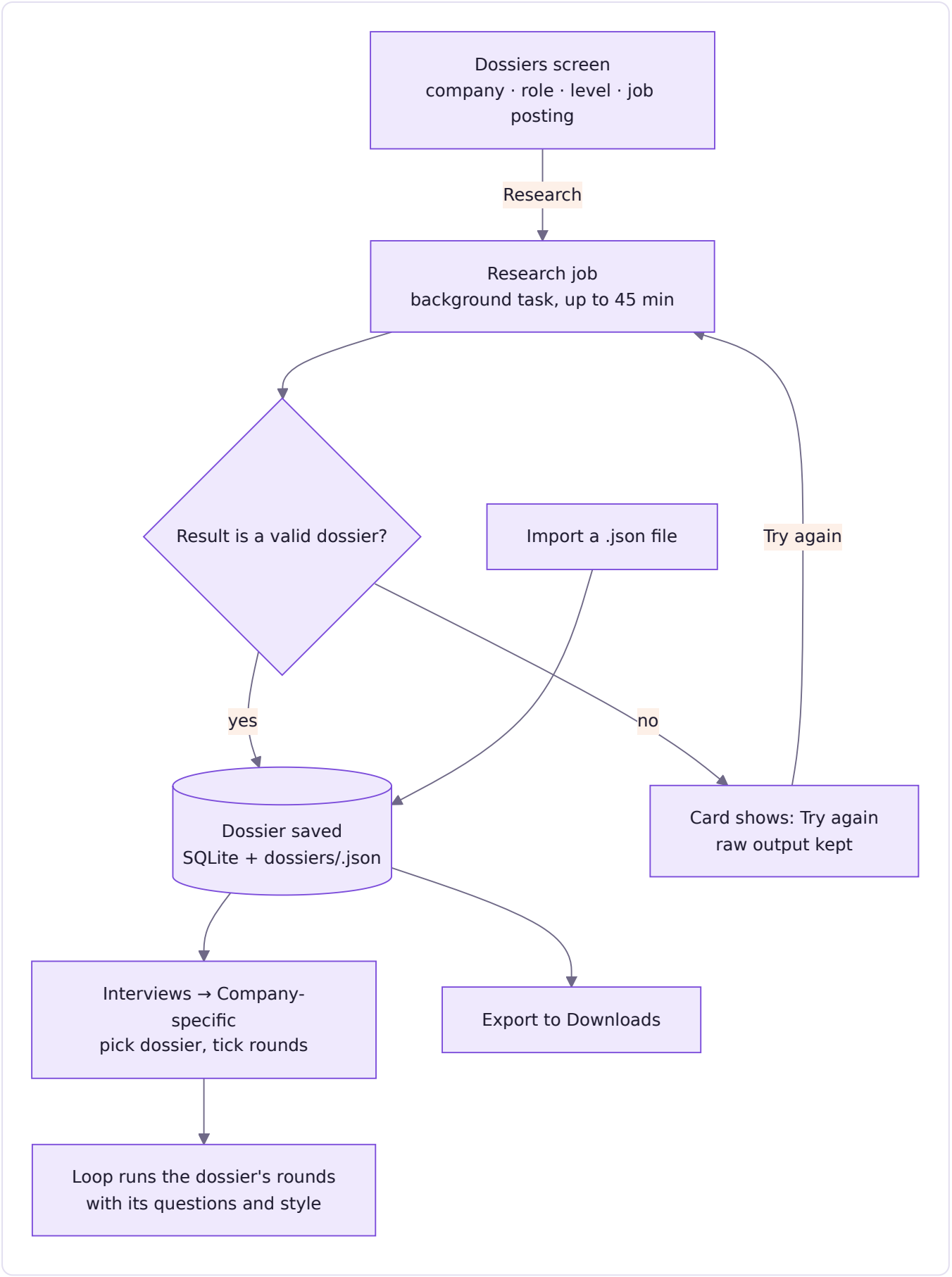
1. Summary

Every company runs its own loop. Onsite can **research** a company and role on the web, from recent candidate reports, and save the result as a **dossier**. A **company-specific loop** then runs that company's rounds, in that order, with that company's reported questions and interviewer style.

2. User stories

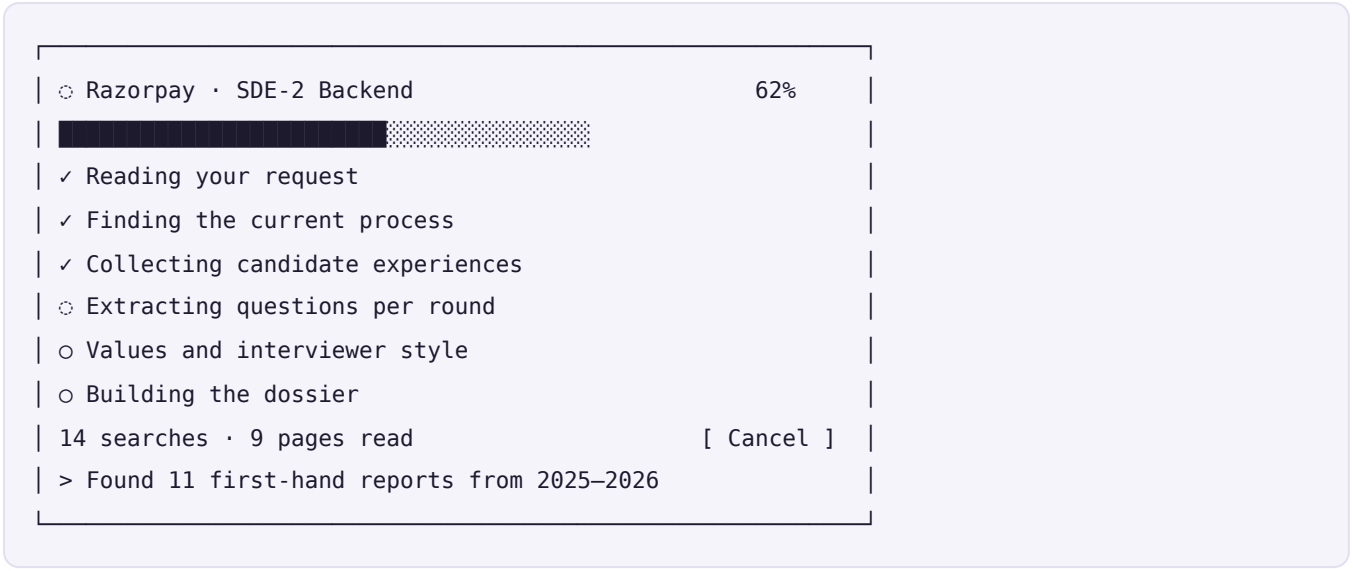
Id	As a candidate I want to…	So that…
RES-S1	type a company, role and level (and paste the posting) and get a dossier	I don't spend an evening reading interview reports
RES-S2	watch real progress while the research runs	I know it's working and roughly how long it will take
RES-S3	read the dossier: rounds, questions, values, pitfalls, sources	I can prepare on my own too
RES-S4	start a loop from the dossier and pick which rounds to run	practice matches the real loop
RES-S5	be asked a coding problem that candidates actually reported	the coding round is company-true
RES-S6	export a dossier and import one a friend made	research is shareable
RES-S7	retry a failed job without losing what was found	a flaky run isn't wasted

3. Flow


Dossiers screen
company · role · level · job posting
Research
Research job
background task, up to 45 min
Result is a valid dossier?
Import a .json file
Try again
yes
no
Dossier saved
SQLite + dossiers/.json
Card shows: Try again
raw output kept
Interviews → Company-specific
pick dossier, tick rounds
Export to Downloads
Loop runs the dossier's rounds
with its questions and style

4. The progress card

A research job is slow (minutes), so the card shows real, not fake, progress:



- **Stage and %** come from `PROGRESS stage=… pct=… note=…` lines the model prints as it works.
- **Searches and pages read** are counted from the real tool calls in the stream.
- Groq does not stream research, so its card jumps from start to done.

5. What a dossier contains

Field	Example (Razorpay SDE-2 Backend, shipped)
`summary`	Typical round order, strictness, where people fail, recent changes.
`style`	How interviewers behave across the loop.
`values`	The company's stated values, with source.
`pitfalls`	Common reasons candidates fail.
`process[]`	One entry per round: `type` (one of the 9 round keys), `name` as the company calls it, `minutes`, `what`, `style`, `questions[]` (4–10 reported questions, paraphrased).
`sources[]`	Title + URL of every report used.

6. Requirements

Id	Requirement	Status
RES-R1	Research uses web search + web fetch **only**. No other tools, on every provider.	Shipped

Id	Requirement	Status
RES-R2	Only questions a source actually reported are included, paraphrased. If evidence is thin, the summary says so.	Shipped (prompt rule)
RES-R3	Prefer reports from 2024 on, weight the last 12 months most, read at least 8 first-hand reports if they exist.	Shipped (prompt rule)
RES-R4	The result is checked against `docs/dossier.schema.json` rules and tidied: round types mapped to known keys, minutes clamped 10–180.	Shipped
RES-R5	Jobs survive navigation inside the app. Jobs still running when the app closes are marked failed on next start.	Shipped
RES-R6	A failed job keeps the raw model output and offers *Try again*.	Shipped
RES-R7	Company loop: the interviewer gets the dossier block (summary, style, values, this round's what/style/questions, pitfalls) and never mentions having it.	Shipped
RES-R8	Company coding round: use a bank problem whose title matches a reported question, else the usual pick.	Shipped
RES-R9	Dossier id = slug(company, role, level). Export writes `<Downloads>/<id>.json`; import takes any such file.	Shipped
RES-R10	The shipped Razorpay dossier is imported once on first run.	Shipped
RES-R11	Research runs in the background while the user does other things. Several jobs can run at once.	Shipped

7. Out of scope / open

- Refreshing an old dossier automatically.
- Merging two dossiers for the same company.
- Surviving an app restart mid-research (today it is marked failed).
- Showing which dossier questions were already asked in past rounds.